‘Arya’, which, if correct, shows that Kharavela saw himself as such. He goes on to declare himself to be a devoted supporter of the Jain religion, after which he enumerates his own many virtues, achievements and public works. Having consolidated his kingdom he had set out on a series of wars against his neighbours, all described with much bombast, starting with a ruler named Satakamini: ‘In the second year, disregarding Satakamini, (he) dispatches to the western regions an army strong in cavalry, elephants, infantry and chariots and by that army having reached the Kanha-bemna [Kanhan and Waingana rivers?], he throws the city of the Musikas [Muziris?] into consternation.’[14] More on this defeated ruler Satakamini (more popularly known as Satakarni) and his long-overlooked dynasty in the next chapter.

Kharavela had next attacked the Graeco-Bactrian ruler Demetrius in the north-west and then the Shungan successors of the Mauryas in Maghada:

> In the twelfth year he terrifies the kings of the Uttarapatha [north country] with ..... thousands of ..... and causing panic amongst the people of Magadha (he) drives (his) elephants into the palace, and makes the King of Magadha, Bahasatimita bow at his feet. And (he) sets up (the image of) ‘the Jina of Kalinga’ which had been taken away by King Nanda ..... and causes to be brought home the riches of Amga and Magadha along with the keepers of the family jewels, horses, elephants, jewels and rubies as well as numerous pearls in hundreds.

Kharavela’s proclamation ends very much as it begins, with the king declaring himself to be ‘the king of peace, the king of prosperity, the king of monks, the king of dharma, who has been seeing, hearing and realising blessings ... respecter of every sect, the repairer of all temples, one